

S-117 Systematics III

Concordia Seminary, St. Louis
(Monday & Thursday 2:35-4:00)

Dr. Joel D. Biermann

Course information

Catalog Course Description

A study of the doctrines of the Holy Spirit, the Word of God, the Christian life, and eschatology.

Course goals

Through readings of primary and secondary sources and class discussions, this course will seek to—nourish in the students:

- Willingness to speak faithfully as servants of the Word;
- Appreciation of theology as an essential church practice;
- Confidence in the Word of God;
- Faith in God, Christ, and the Spirit.
- a love for the study of theology and its practical relevance for ministry and life.

develop in the students the ability to:.

- Describe and understand the role of Holy Scripture in the life of the Church.
- Construct a proper articulation of the Christian life as new obedience.
- Articulate an accurate understanding of Baptism and the Lord's Supper as means of grace.
- Distinguish orthodox eschatological expression from errant eschatological teachings.
- Recognize and characterize theological issues and situations in the world.

develop in the students their knowledge and understanding of:

- The person of the Holy Spirit and his activity in the Church and the Believer.
- The orthodox expressions of the doctrines of pneumatology.
- The nature and uses of doctrine in the life of the church.

Course procedure

The ordinary procedure will be for students to read the material assigned for each class period, attend the scheduled lecture, and participate in class discussion.

Course outline and schedule

March 6

Introduction

March 9

Congar vol. 1, 3-62

March 13

Prenter 3-64

Congar vol. 3, 49-56, 199-207

CTCR "Charismatic Movement" (either year is fine...)

March 16

Pieper 3:103-142, 183-189

Prenter 101-172

Sasse, "On the ... Holy Spirit" (3:17-39)

March 20

Childs "Problem"
Pieper 1:193-232

March 23

Pieper 1:232-265
CTCR "Inspiration" 1975

March 27

Pieper 3:253-263
Sasse, "Holy Baptism" (2:36-48)
Förde, *Where God meets Man*, 68-88.

March 30

Pieper 3:263-289
LC IV on infant baptism (KW 462-467)

April 3

Examination #1

April 6

Pieper 3:290-349, 373-380

April 10

Sasse, "The Lord's Supper in NT" & "The Lord's Supper in the Lutheran Church" (2:49-112)
Sasse, "Lutheran Understanding of Consecration" (2:113-138)

April 20

CTCR "Admission to LS"
Pieper 3:189-203

April 24

Köberle 1-83

April 27

Köberle 84-205
Prenter 64-100

May 1

Köberle 206-268
Pieper 3:52-61
Wingren

May 4

Wingren

May 8

Pieper 3:507-555

Paper Due

May 11

Long, Thomas G. "The Life to Come"
CTCR "Death"
Kreeft Introduction, chapters 2 & 6

May 15

CTCR "The 'End Times'"
Gibbs, "Five Things You Should Not Say..."

May 18

Examination #2

Course books and Articles

Childs, Brevard S. "The Problem of the Christian Bible," in *Biblical Theology of the Old and New Testaments: Theological Reflection on the Christian Bible*. Fortress Press, ISBN: 978-0800698324 (pages 55-68)

Congar, Yves. *I Believe in the Holy Spirit*. Crossroads. ISBN: 978-0824516963 (pages 3-62, vol. 3 49-56, 199-207)

Förde, *Where God meets Man*, Fortress Press, ISBN: 978-0806612355 (pages 68-88)

Gibbs, Jeffery A. "Five Things You Should *Not* Say at Funerals," *Concordia Journal* 29 (2003), 363-369.

Köberle, Adolf. *The Quest for Holiness*. reprint ed. Wipf & Stock. ISBN: 978-1592448395

Kreeft, Peter. *Everything You Ever Wanted to Know about Heaven: But Never Dreamed of Asking*. San Francisco: Ignatius Press, 1990. ISBN: 978-0-89870-297-2 (Intro, Chapters 2 & 6)

Long, Thomas G. "The Life to Come: Preaching with Hope," *Concordia Journal* 22 (1996), 352-369.

Pieper, Francis. *Christian Dogmatics*. Vols. 1 & 3. St. Louis: CPH. ISBN: 978-0570067153

Prenter, Regin. *Spiritus Creator* reprint ed. Wipf and Stock. ISBN: 978-1579106263

Sasse, Herman. "*We Confess*" *Anthology*. CPH. ISBN: 978-0570042785 (pages 3:17-39, 2:36-138)

Wingren, Gustaf. *Luther on Vocation*. reprint ed. Wipf & Stock ISBN: 978-1592445615